

Jalal Sikandar

Cloud Support Engineer | Linux Engineer

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Profile

Linux System Engineer with 4+ years of hands-on experience operating and automating high-availability Linux server environments. Strong command-line expertise across Debian, CentOS, and RHEL, with deep exposure to MySQL replication, web and mail stacks, virtualisation, and infrastructure automation. Passionate about clean systems, performance tuning, and replacing legacy processes with scalable automation. Thrives in flat hierarchies, agile teams, and technically driven environments.

Professional Experience

DigitalOcean

2020/11 – 2025/03

Engineer II

U.S.A

- Operated and maintained high-availability Linux server environments supporting production workloads.
- Administered Debian, CentOS, and RHEL systems, performing system hardening, upgrades, and performance tuning.
- Configured and supported MySQL replication setups, handling backups, failover scenarios, and data consistency issues.
- Wrote shell and Python scripts for operational automation, monitoring, and maintenance tasks.
- Collaborated closely with Hosting, Networking, and Data Centre Operations teams to resolve infrastructure issues end-to-end.
- Deployed and tuned open-source web stacks including Apache, Nginx, Varnish, Tomcat, and PHP-based applications.
- Managed mail services using Postfix and Dovecot, including troubleshooting delivery and authentication issues.
- Automated server provisioning, configuration, and maintenance using Ansible, significantly reducing manual effort and configuration drift.

Skills

- **Linux & Operating Systems:** Debian, CentOS, RHEL, Systemd, Storage & Performance Tuning, Bash Scripting
- **Web, Mail & Application Stacks:** Apache, Nginx, Tomcat, Varnish, Postfix, Dovecot, PHP-based Hosting Environments
- **Databases:** MySQL / MariaDB, Replication, Clustering Concepts, Backups, Performance Tuning, Data Consistency Troubleshooting
- **Automation & Configuration Management:** Ansible (production use), Puppet (working knowledge), Infrastructure Standardization & Repeatable Deployments
- **Scripting & Programming:** Bash, Python, Familiarity with PHP & Java-based Applications

- **Infrastructure & Networking:** DNS, TCP/IP, Firewalling, Monitoring, Logging, System Health Checks

Key Achievements

Malware Protection:

I implemented the Malware Protection add-on at Cloudways using Imunify360, CI/CD pipelines, Terraform, and Ansible. This reduced reported malware infections by **40%**, automated threat detection and cleanup, and significantly lowered user-reported cases via chats and support tickets, enhancing overall platform security.

Safe Updates

I played a pivotal role in developing and deploying the SafeUpdates feature by utilizing Jenkins, Docker, and Kubernetes to enhance update reliability and security. This effort contributed to a 15% increase in customer satisfaction scores by delivering safer, more dependable software updates.

Network Security Solution

Designed and deployed a secure, scalable Food Safety platform infrastructure using Terraform, Ansible, and AWS. Leveraged public/private subnets, ALB, and Auto Scaling for high availability and seamless scaling. Enabled zero-downtime blue/green deployments and sandbox testing. Automated configuration hardening and patching for CIS compliance. Implemented continuous monitoring, alerting, and threat detection with CloudWatch, GuardDuty, and WAF, enhancing security and operational resilience.

Education

Arden University

2026

Master of Science (M.Sc.) in Cyber Security

SZABIST

2020/08

Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) in Computer Science

Languages

English

IELTS - C1

Deutsch